Pitch 1 Poverty Breakdown in Syracuse

For my final project, I want to analyze poverty in Syracuse and break down which groups are most affected and why the issue is so much more severe in the city compared to the surrounding area. Poverty is one of the biggest problems facing Syracuse, and it impacts everything from education and job opportunities to housing and long-term financial stability. According to U.S. Census data, about 26% of people in Syracuse live below the poverty line, compared to just 12.5% in Onondaga County overall. That gap shows there is a clear divide between the city and the rest of the county.

What stands out even more is how much poverty affects certain groups. For example, around 41% of children under 18 in Syracuse are living in poverty, and that number is even higher for kids under five, at nearly 50%. That's not just a statistic; it has real consequences for education, development, and future opportunities. This is why I think this story matters. It's not just about how many people are in poverty, but about who is affected and what that says about inequality in the city. The dataset I am using comes from the U.S. Census Bureau's American Community Survey (ACS). This is a government dataset that includes detailed information on poverty rates, population totals, and demographic breakdowns. The data I collected includes both Syracuse and Onondaga County, and it breaks things down by age, race, gender, education level, and employment status. Since this is raw data and not already summarized, I can analyze it myself in Google Sheets and look for patterns.

The main questions I want to answer are: Why is poverty so much higher in Syracuse than in the rest of the county? Which groups are most affected? And how do factors like education and employment relate to poverty? From looking at the data so far, there are clear patterns. Poverty is much higher among people with lower levels of education and among those who are unemployed, which suggests that access to education and stable jobs plays a major role. There are some limitations to the data. The ACS uses estimates, so there are margins of error, and the data only shows one point in time instead of trends over multiple years. It also doesn't explain the exact causes of poverty, so I'll need to use reporting and interviews to add context.

For my analysis, I plan to compare Syracuse to Onondaga County and then break the data down into categories like age, race, education, and employment. I will use Google Sheets to sort and filter the data and calculate differences between groups. I also plan to create visualizations like bar charts showing poverty rates across different groups and a comparison chart between the city and the county to make the data easier to understand. To support the data, I will include interviews with a Syracuse resident experiencing poverty, someone who works at a local nonprofit or social services organization, and a policy expert or professor. These sources will help explain what the data means in real life and give more insight into the causes of poverty.

Pitch 2 crime syracuse

For my second project, I want to analyze crime trends in Syracuse and compare them to those in the surrounding areas in Onondaga County. Crime is something that people in the community talk about a lot, but the conversation is often based on perception rather than actual data. I want to use this project to look at what the data actually shows and whether crime in Syracuse is getting better, worse, or just changing over time. This story matters because crime directly impacts how safe people feel in their communities, and it also influences public policy, policing strategies, and local decision-making. Looking at long-term data can help show whether concerns about crime are supported by evidence or if trends are more complicated than they seem. It also allows for a comparison between Syracuse and nearby suburban areas, which can highlight differences within the same county.

The dataset I am using comes from reported crime data in Onondaga County, including the Syracuse Police Department and surrounding agencies like North Syracuse and East Syracuse. The data includes yearly totals for overall crime, violent crime, and property crime, along with specific categories such as murder, robbery, burglary, and larceny. Because the dataset spans multiple decades, it allows for a long-term analysis of how crime has changed over time .

The main questions I want to answer are: How has crime in Syracuse changed over time? Has violent crime increased or decreased compared to property crime? And how does crime in Syracuse compare to nearby suburban areas like North Syracuse and East Syracuse? From an initial look at the data, there are noticeable changes over time. For example, total crime in Syracuse appears to have decreased significantly since the 1990s, but there are also recent increases in certain categories like violent crime. There are some limitations to this dataset. The data represents reported crimes, which means it may not capture all incidents. Additionally, differences in reporting practices over time or between agencies could affect comparisons. The dataset also does not include population data, so crime rates per capita would require additional data to fully understand trends. For my analysis, I plan to focus on trends over time and comparisons between locations. Using Google Sheets, I will organize the data by year and agency, and then create trendlines showing changes in total crime, violent crime, and property crime. I also plan to compare Syracuse to nearby suburban police departments to highlight differences within the county. For visualization, I will create line graphs showing crime trends over time, as well as comparisons between different types of crime. These visuals will make it easier to see long-term patterns and shifts in crime. To support the data, I will include interviews with a local resident, a law enforcement officer or public safety official, and a criminal justice expert or professor. These sources will help explain what the trends mean and provide context beyond the numbers.